

Colour To Life

Light up the world with
your gaze

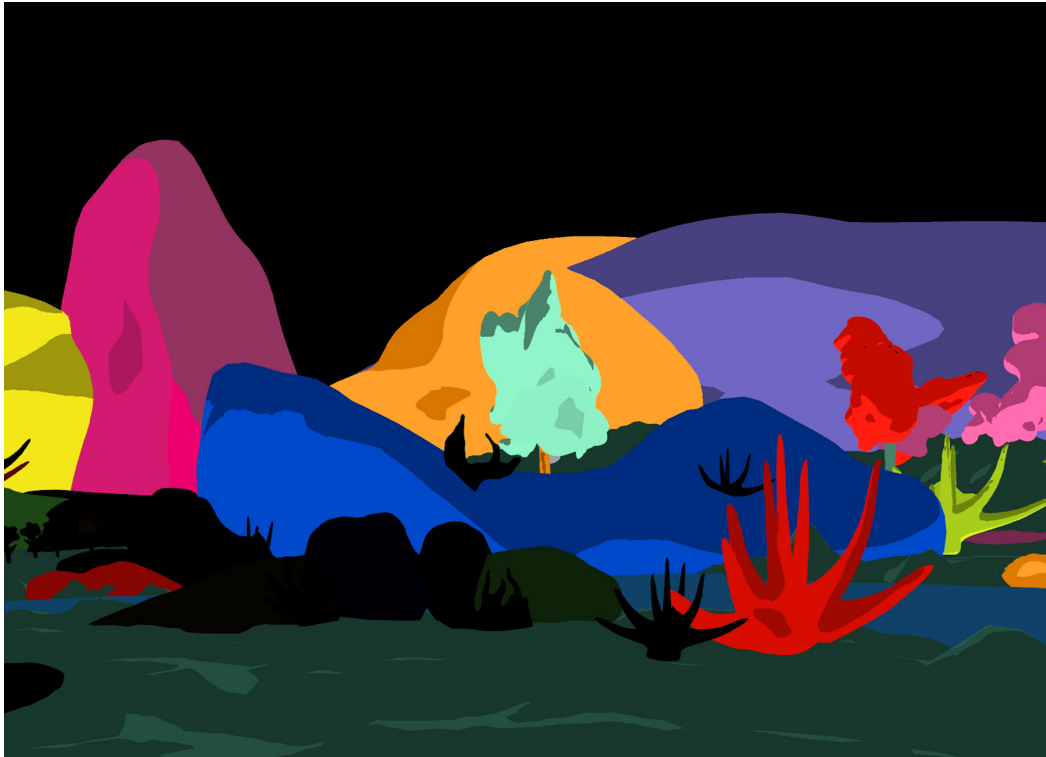
Presentation

“Colour to Life” is a game where players can breathe life into their environment through the power of their gaze. Placed in complete darkness, they gently illuminate their surroundings, one object at a time. The more they discover the landscape, the more lively it becomes through vibrant colours and relaxing sounds, creating a world of wonder.



Objectives

This project was created for the Possible Bodies workshop, a collaboration between the Master Media Design, HEAD – Genève and Swiss Paraplegic Group (SWP). The five-week workshop focused on creating playful virtual reality experiences to facilitate the rehabilitation of people with motor difficulties. Our mission in this project was to develop a unique prototype that uses immersive gameplay to explore new potentials for rehabilitation.



Inspiration

During our discovery period with the Swiss Paraplegic Group, we were inspired by their stories. One patient was able to tell you exactly how many holes are in a ceiling panel, while another expressed that painting is their form of play. We wanted to tap into these two insights by having observation and creative expression at the forefront of our game.

The simplicity of our game is reminiscent of colourful classics like Where's Wally and Paint-by-Numbers. But rather than starting with a visible scene, everything begins in darkness. Colouring in larger elements, such as the terrain and mountains, helps with revealing smaller details. Like in Where's Wally, you'll need to scan the landscape carefully and pay close attention to your surroundings. The game ends only once the entire scene has been brought to life.

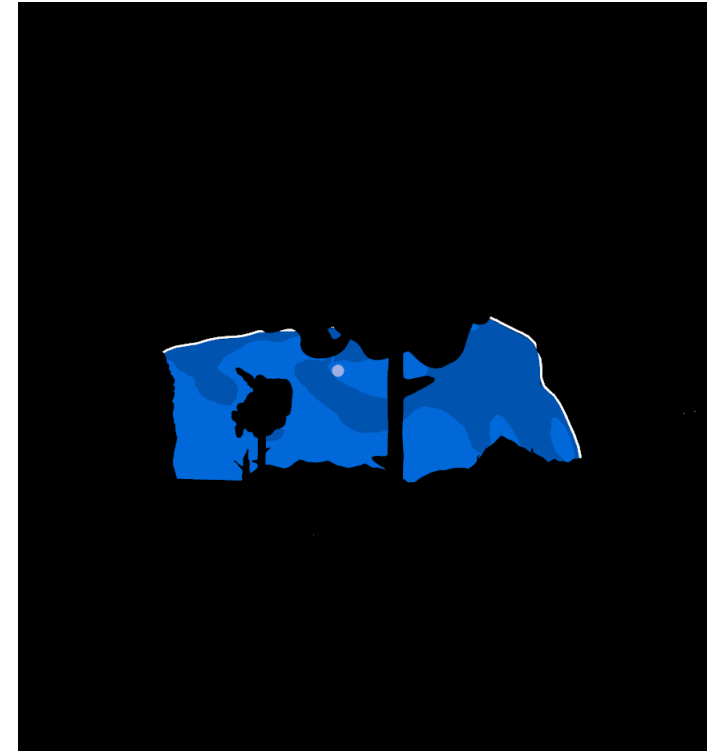
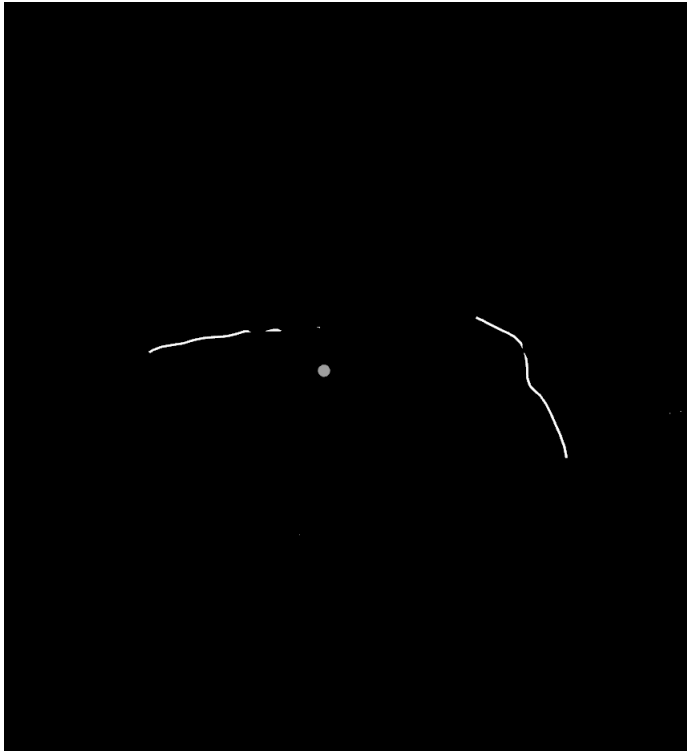


Experience

Starting in a pitch black space, the environment is waiting to be revealed. The player just has to simply look around in order to light up the world around them.

When an object is looked at, a white outline will highlight it while producing a relaxing sound to indicate that the object has been selected. The longer the player looks at it, the more lively it will become.

From a lifeless black object, it will fade into a beautiful colour following by shading to give it dimension. The player will always be able to change the colour afterwards by gazing back at it.



Autonomy and Accessibility

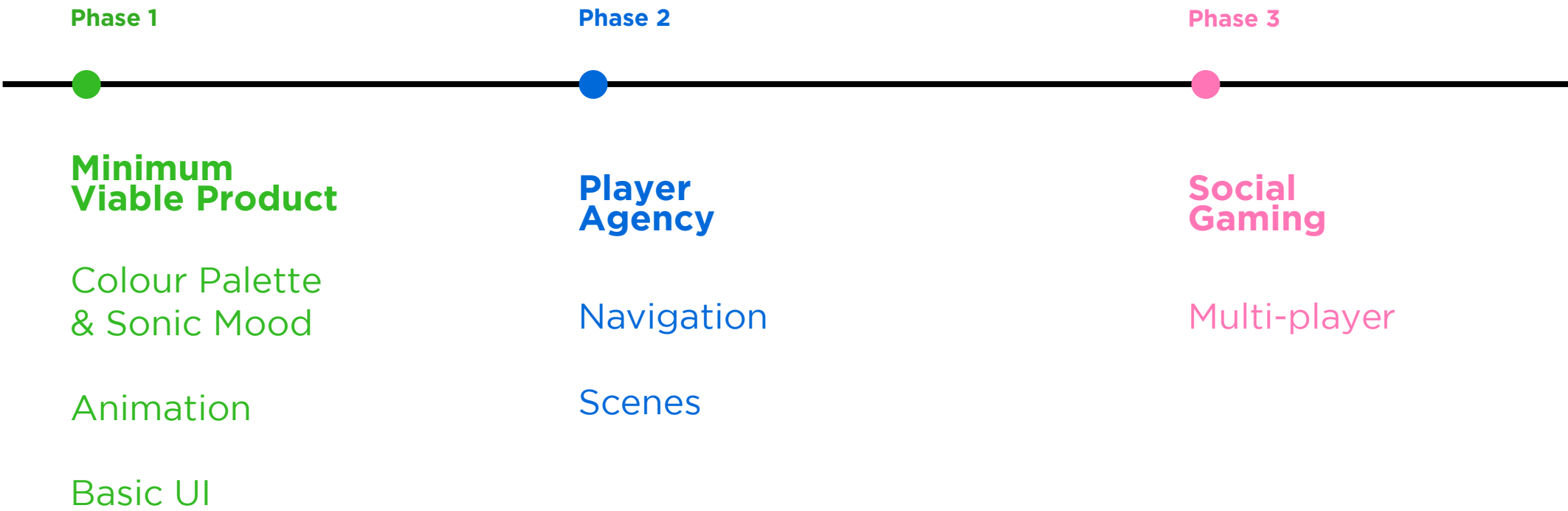
We intentionally designed a straightforward game. Because our audience has limited mobility, we focused on a single input they have access to, which is their head movement. The gameplay is kept simple, and the name of the game clearly communicates what players are meant to do. This reduces complexity in a medium that can often feel overwhelming. However, the experience remains engaging, as players retain autonomy in how they choose to colour their landscape.

While the game was originally designed for paraplegic players, it can be enjoyed by anyone with control over their head movements. Even without understanding English, players can grasp the interaction during onboarding—colouring each letter of the title—thanks to clear visual feedback like outlines and colour changes. Since this is the core and only interaction, the gameplay is intuitive and easy to understand.

Future Development

Roadmap

This is a prototype with the core elements figured out such as the game mechanic and aesthetics. We have also thought about how to expand on our idea to make it a fully playable game.



Future Development

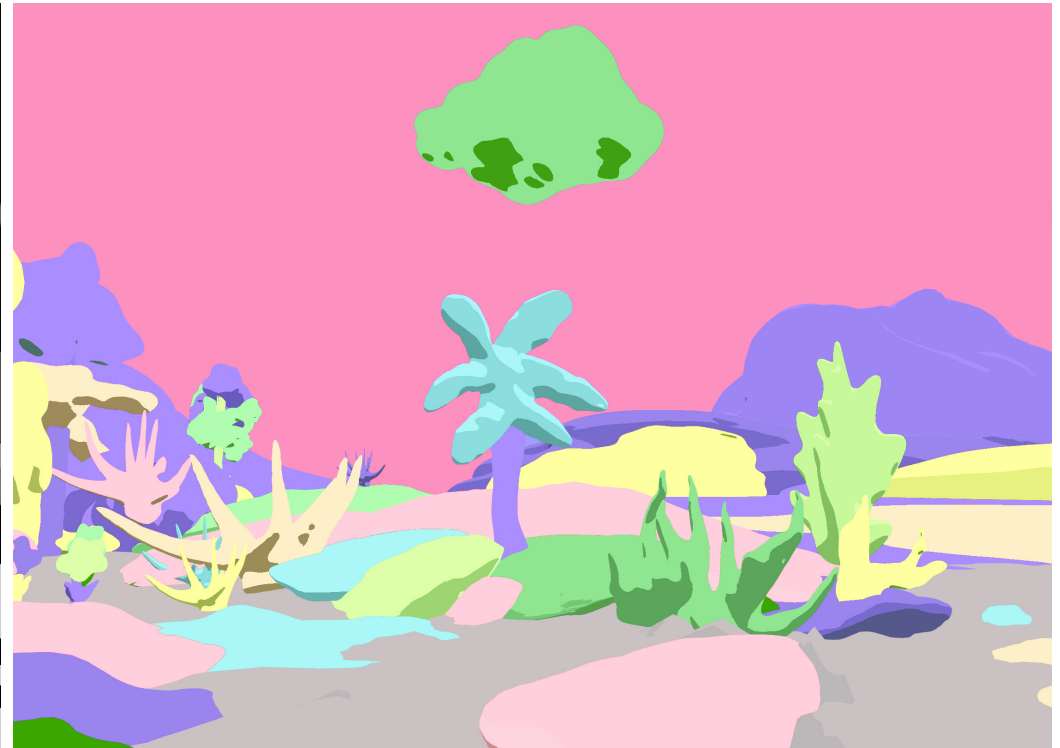
Colour Palette & Sonic Mood

To reflect creative expression, we want players to be able to select pre-define colour palettes based on moods. These colour palettes will also change the sounds to reflect the tone of the scenes.

SOMBRE



SOOTHING



Future Development

Animation & UI

To truly make the landscapes come to life, we will incorporate animations. The animations will activate as the last state of an object after it has been fully coloured and shaded. Another idea is to have moving elements like birds or the clouds that you have to catch them with your gaze.

We will also need to think about how to include a user interface so players can perform basic actions such as save and reset.

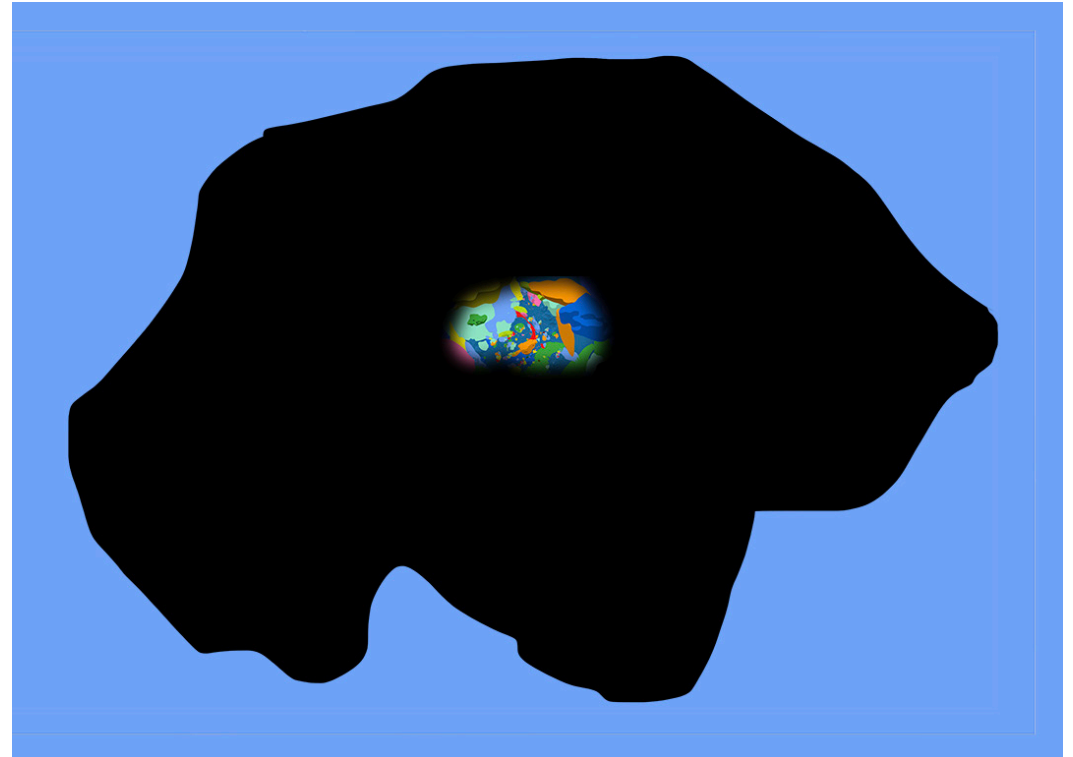


Future Development

Navigation

In second phase, players would be able to explore more of the world. Once a scene is fully coloured, a portal will appear, allowing players to teleport to that area to discover more of the unseen world around.

Phase 2: Player Agency



Future Development

Phase 2: Player Agency

Scenes

The game gradually becomes more challenging as more objects appear to be coloured. For example, at the mountaintop, a winter wonderland scene introduces snow-covered areas, making it harder to fully colour the environment.

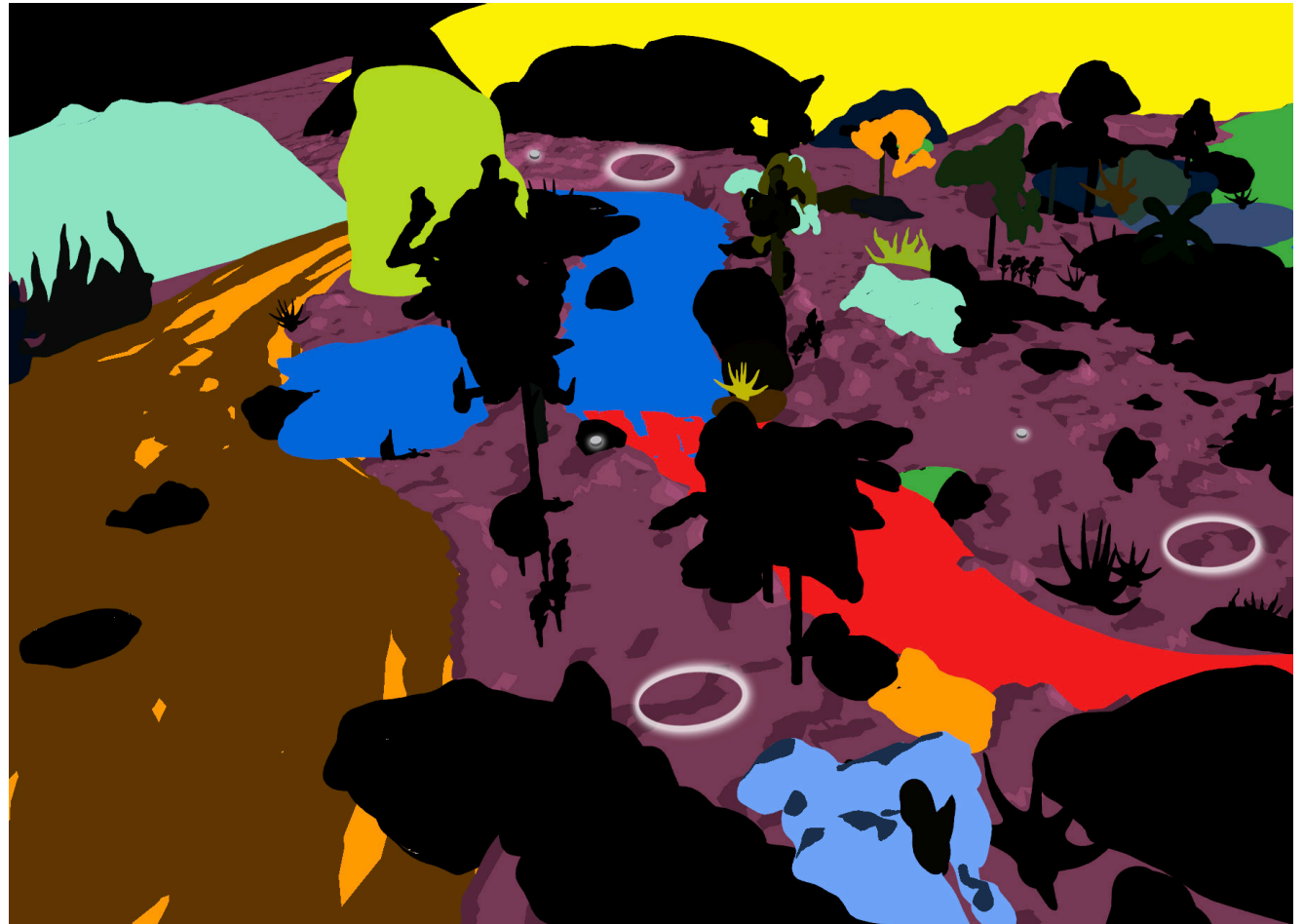


Future Development

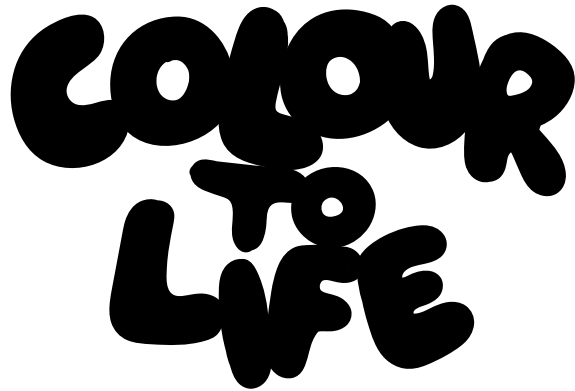
Phase 3: Social Gaming

Multi-player

Our ultimate goal is to turn this into a multiplayer experience. Patients in recovery are often isolated, even when others nearby are going through similar challenges. By enabling them to colour together and talk to one another, we hope to make their recovery feel less lonely.



Credits



Design & Development

Antonin Ricou, Student
Peter Ha, Student

Master Media Design Staff

Alexia Mathieu, Department Director
Douglas Edric Stanley, Project Lead
Sabrina Calvo, Concept & Writing
Pierre Rossel, Development
Andreia Rodrigues, Production Assistant

Made With

Unity
Cinema4D
Zbrush
Adobe Illustrator
Adobe Photoshop
Figma
GarageBand
ChatGPT
Visual Code Studio
GitHub Co-Pilot